BitcoinTX CSV Import Guide

Overview

The CSV Import feature allows you to bulk-import your Bitcoin transaction history into BitcoinTX. This is useful for:

- Setting up a new installation with existing data
- Migrating from another tracking system
- Restoring from a CSV backup

Important: The database must be empty before importing. This ensures clean FIFO cost basis calculations. If you have existing transactions, delete them first from the Settings page. To add an exchange's own CSV export to a ledger in use, use Settings → Import from an exchange instead.

Quick Start Guide

Step 1: Download the Template

Go to Settings → Data Management and click "Template" under Import Transactions (CSV). This gives you a CSV file with the correct column headers and sample rows.

Step 2: Fill in Your Data

Open the template in a spreadsheet application (Excel, Google Sheets, etc.) and replace the sample rows with your actual transaction data. Delete any sample rows you don't need.

Step 3: Preview the Import

Upload your CSV file and click "Preview". The system validates all rows and shows you any errors or warnings. Fix any issues before proceeding.

Step 4: Execute the Import

If the preview shows no errors, click "Import" to create all transactions. The import is atomic – if anything fails, no transactions are created.

Field Reference

CSV Columns

Column	Required	Description
date	Yes	Date/time (ISO8601 preferred). Without a timezone it is in your tax timezone (Settings → Account); a date alone means noon
type	Yes	Transaction type: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, Sell
amount	Yes	BTC (up to 8 decimals), or USD for a dollar account's rows (a bank, an exchange's USD). BTC Transfer: what left the account, fee included. USD Transfer (between dollar accounts): what arrived, fee on top. Withdrawal: what the recipient got, fee on top
from_account	Yes	Source account: one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External
to_account	Yes	Destination account: one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External
cost_basis_usd	Conditional	Buy: USD paid for the BTC, before the fee (the fee column is added to the basis). BTC Deposit: required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate blank = that hour's value; Inherited: its value on the date of death, blank = that day's value
proceeds_usd	Conditional	Sell: gross USD, before the fee (the fee is subtracted). Spent withdrawal: value received, before the network fee (the fee's value is subtracted); blank = that hour's value
fee_amount	No	Fee amount (never also included in cost_basis_usd or proceeds_usd)
fee_currency	No	USD or BTC. Blank = USD for a Buy or Sell, else the currency of the account it's paid from (a deposit's: the account it goes into), the only one it may be in
source	No	For Deposits: N/A, MyBTC, Gift, Inherited, Income, Interest, Reward, Rebate
purpose	Conditional	A BTC withdrawal (from a wallet or an exchange's BTC): Spent, Gift, Donation or Lost. From a bank or an exchange's USD: any short text on one line, or blank; Spent, Gift, Donation or Lost isn't kept there
notes	No	Optional notes (not imported, for your reference only)
fee_usd	No	Transfer/Withdrawal with a BTC fee: what the fee was worth in USD. Blank = fee x that hour's BTC price
fmv_usd	No	Gift, Donation or Lost withdrawal: its fair market value when it left (shown in the tax report); blank = the BTC price when its hour began x the amount (that day's where there's no hourly price), or blank without a price
broker_reporting	No	Sell/Withdrawal: only when your broker's 1099-DA/1099-B differs: none, proceeds or basis. Blank = automatic
fee_usd_typed	No	With fee_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed that value, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)
cost_basis_typed	No	Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate/Inherited deposit with cost_basis_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)

acquired_at	Conditional	MyBTC or Gift deposit into a wallet or an exchange's BTC: when the coins were first acquired (by the giver, for a gift); blank = the deposit's date. Inherited: the date of death (required)
proceeds_typed	No	Spent withdrawal with proceeds_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed them, no if they came from the price (the export writes it)
price_moment	No	With a value from the price: hour (the BTC price when its hour began, UTC) or day (that day's 00:00 UTC price). Blank = day (the export writes it)
fmv_typed	No	Gift/Donation/Lost withdrawal with fmv_usd: yes (or blank) if you typed it, no if it came from the price (the export writes it)

Settings > Export CSV writes these same columns, so an export imports back to the same ledger.

Transaction Types

Type	Description
Deposit	Money or BTC coming in from outside (BTC you held elsewhere, a gift received, income; dollars into a bank or an exchange's USD)
Withdrawal	Money or BTC leaving (BTC spent, given, donated or lost; dollars out of a bank or an exchange's USD)
Transfer	Moving money or BTC between your own accounts (not a sale; a BTC network fee is a small disposal). A wallet to itself: a consolidation, where only the fee is recorded
Buy	Purchasing BTC on an exchange with USD
Sell	Selling BTC on an exchange for USD

Account Names

Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD and Exchange BTC always mean your first bank, wallet and exchange, as in BitcoinTX 1.x's files, whatever they are called now. BTC Fees and USD Fees are the ledger's own: no row names them.

Account	Description
Your accounts	Your banks, wallets and exchanges, each by its name in Settings (in any case). A bank holds USD, a wallet BTC; an exchange has two accounts, "<name> USD" and "<name> BTC". A hidden account still imports, with a warning
Bank	Your first bank account (USD)
Wallet	Your first self-custody Bitcoin wallet
Exchange USD	Your first exchange's USD balance
Exchange BTC	Your first exchange's BTC balance
External	Outside your portfolio (source for deposits, destination for withdrawals)

Source Values (for Deposits)

Value	Description
N/A	Not applicable or unspecified
MyBTC	BTC you already owned (transferring in)
Gift	Received as a gift (cost_basis_usd: the giver's basis, 0 if unknown)
Inherited	Inherited from someone who died: acquired_at is the date of death (required), cost_basis_usd its value that day (or on the estate's alternate valuation date; a Form 8971 value that increased the estate tax caps it); always long-term, INHERITED on Form 8949
Income	Payment for goods/services
Interest	Earned as interest
Reward	Mining, staking, or a sign-up or referral bonus (income)
Rebate	Bitcoin back for spending, such as a rewards card's sats-back (not income; its value is its cost basis)

Purpose Values (for BTC Withdrawals)

Value	Description
Spent	Used to purchase goods/services (taxable sale)
Gift	Given as a gift
Donation	Donated to charity
Lost	Lost or stolen BTC

Account Rules by Transaction Type

Each transaction type has specific account requirements. The system enforces these rules during validation.

Type	From Account	To Account	Required Fields
Deposit	External	Any of your accounts	Into a bitcoin account (a wallet, or an exchange's BTC): cost_basis_usd required (0 if unknown); Income/Interest/Reward/Rebate: blank = that hour's value; Inherited: acquired_at (date of death) required; blank = that day's value
Withdrawal	Any of your accounts	External	From a bitcoin account (a wallet, or an exchange's BTC): purpose required; proceeds_usd for "Spent"
Transfer	One of your accounts	Another of your accounts, in the same currency; or the same bitcoin account	Fee in the sending account's currency; to the same account (a consolidation): a BTC fee is required, and only it is recorded
Buy	A bank, or an exchange's USD	An exchange's BTC (the same exchange's, when paid from its USD)	cost_basis_usd required; fee must be USD
Sell	An exchange's BTC	The same exchange's USD	proceeds_usd required; fee must be USD

Supported Date Formats

The following date formats are accepted. ISO8601 with timezone is recommended. A date or time without a timezone is read in your tax timezone (Settings → Account), and a date alone means noon that day, so it stays in the right tax year:

Format	Example
ISO8601 with Z (preferred)	2024-01-15T10:30:00Z
ISO8601 with timezone	2024-01-15T10:30:00+00:00
ISO8601 without timezone	2024-01-15T10:30:00
Date with time	2024-01-15 10:30:00
Date only	2024-01-15
US format with time	01/15/2024 10:30:00
US format date only	01/15/2024

Example Rows

Below are example CSV rows for each transaction type. Use these as templates for your own data.

Buy from Exchange USD:

```
2024-01-15T10:30:00Z,Buy,0.012,Exchange USD,Exchange BTC,500.00,,5.00,USD,,,
```

Buy from Bank (auto-buy):

```
2024-01-20T08:00:00Z,Buy,0.05,Bank,Exchange BTC,2500.00,,10.00,USD,,,
```

Sell (selling BTC on exchange):

```
2024-02-15T11:30:00Z,Sell,0.3,Exchange BTC,Exchange USD,,15000.00,10.00,USD,,,
```

Deposit (BTC entering your wallet):

```
2024-01-20T14:00:00Z,Deposit,0.5,External,Wallet,21000.00,,,,Income,,
```

Withdrawal (spending BTC):

```
2024-03-01T09:00:00Z,Withdrawal,0.1,Wallet,External,,5500.00,,,,Spent,
```

Transfer (moving between wallets):

```
2024-02-01T16:45:00Z,Transfer,1.0,Exchange BTC,Wallet,,,0.0001,BTC,,,
```

Transfer of USD with a fee ($1,000 left the bank, $990 arrived: amount 990, the $10 fee on top):

```
2024-02-03T12:00:00Z,Transfer,990.00,Bank,Exchange USD,,,10.00,USD,,,
```

Transfer within the wallet (a consolidation: only the fee):

```
2024-02-05T09:00:00Z,Transfer,0.4,Wallet,Wallet,,,0.00005,BTC,,,
```

Troubleshooting

Common Errors

Error	Solution
"Database has X existing transactions"	Delete all transactions from Settings before importing
"Invalid type '...'"	Use exactly: Deposit, Withdrawal, Transfer, Buy, or Sell

"Invalid account '...'"	Use one of your accounts by its name in Settings, or External (the error lists them). Bank, Wallet, Exchange USD and Exchange BTC always mean your first bank, wallet and exchange
"... is hidden in Settings" (a warning)	The row imports; show the account again in Settings if you still use it
"cost_basis_usd is required for Buy transactions"	Add the USD paid for the BTC, before the fee
"proceeds_usd is required for Sell transactions"	Add the gross USD, before the fee
"A BTC withdrawal needs a purpose"	From a wallet or an exchange's BTC, add purpose: Spent, Gift, Donation, or Lost
"A Buy is paid from a bank or from an exchange's USD account"	Buy must be: from a bank or an exchange's USD, to an exchange's BTC (the same exchange's, when paid from its USD)
"A Sell is from an exchange's BTC account"	Sell must be: from an exchange's BTC, to the same exchange's USD
"A Deposit comes from External"	Deposit must be: from External, to one of your accounts
"A Transfer goes to another account: only a bitcoin account can send to itself"	Only a wallet or an exchange's BTC can send to itself (a consolidation); a dollar account can't
"A move within the same account records only its network fee"	A transfer from a wallet (or an exchange's BTC) to itself needs its fee_amount in BTC

Tip: Use the Preview feature to validate your CSV before importing. Fix all errors shown in red before clicking Import.